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Fireclay Tile

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Entry-Level Technologist position at Fireclay Tile. This role stood out to me because it combines two sides of my background that I genuinely enjoy: hands-on IT support for real users and building software tools that make business operations smoother.

I recently completed my Bachelor of Science in Computer Science at the University of Oregon, and my experience spans helpdesk support, web development, automation, and full-stack software projects. Earlier in my career, I worked as a Computer Helpdesk Technician at Pacific University, where I diagnosed hardware and software issues, restored devices, installed systems, configured equipment, and helped faculty and students get back to work. I understand the importance of being reliable, approachable, and able to explain technical issues clearly to people who are not engineers.

At the same time, I have been building toward software engineering roles where I can own projects end-to-end. My project work includes full-stack applications using React, TypeScript, Python, backend APIs, databases, authentication, deployment workflows, and AI-assisted development tools. In Syllabify, I helped build an academic planning web application that parsed syllabi, extracted assignments, and generated conflict-aware schedules around calendar data. In Backlog, I built a job search platform that aggregates roles, normalizes messy data, scores role fit with AI, and helps automate parts of the application workflow.

What I like about Fireclay Tile's position is that the software work is grounded in real operational problems. The idea of partnering with production and operations teams to turn "we keep doing this in a spreadsheet" into an internal tool is exactly the kind of practical software I enjoy building. I am comfortable working with users to understand the actual workflow, identifying where the friction is, and then building a maintainable tool, script, dashboard, or integration to remove that friction.

I am also very comfortable with AI-assisted development tools such as Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, and ChatGPT. I use AI to accelerate development, but not to skip understanding. I review generated code, test it, understand the tradeoffs, and make the final engineering decisions myself.

I think that mindset fits this role well: moving quickly with modern tools while still caring about reliability, documentation, and long-term maintainability.

I would be excited to bring my mix of IT support experience, software development skills, curiosity, and user-focused problem solving to Fireclay Tile. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Thanks for your time,

Kenny Nguyen